

EXAMPLE Forms™ Overview

This overview contains a description of EXAMPLE Forms™ in the EXAMPLE Platform®. It outlines the major uses of EXAMPLE Forms™ and the main features that make it a flexible solution for the creation and generation of policy documents.

What Is EXAMPLE Forms™?

The EXAMPLE Forms™ component of the EXAMPLE Platform® helps ease the integration of forms provider products into the EXAMPLE Platform® and provides a simple, integrated way to generate documents in .pdf, .doc, .rtf, or .htm format. You can use the EXAMPLE Forms™ engine in three ways.

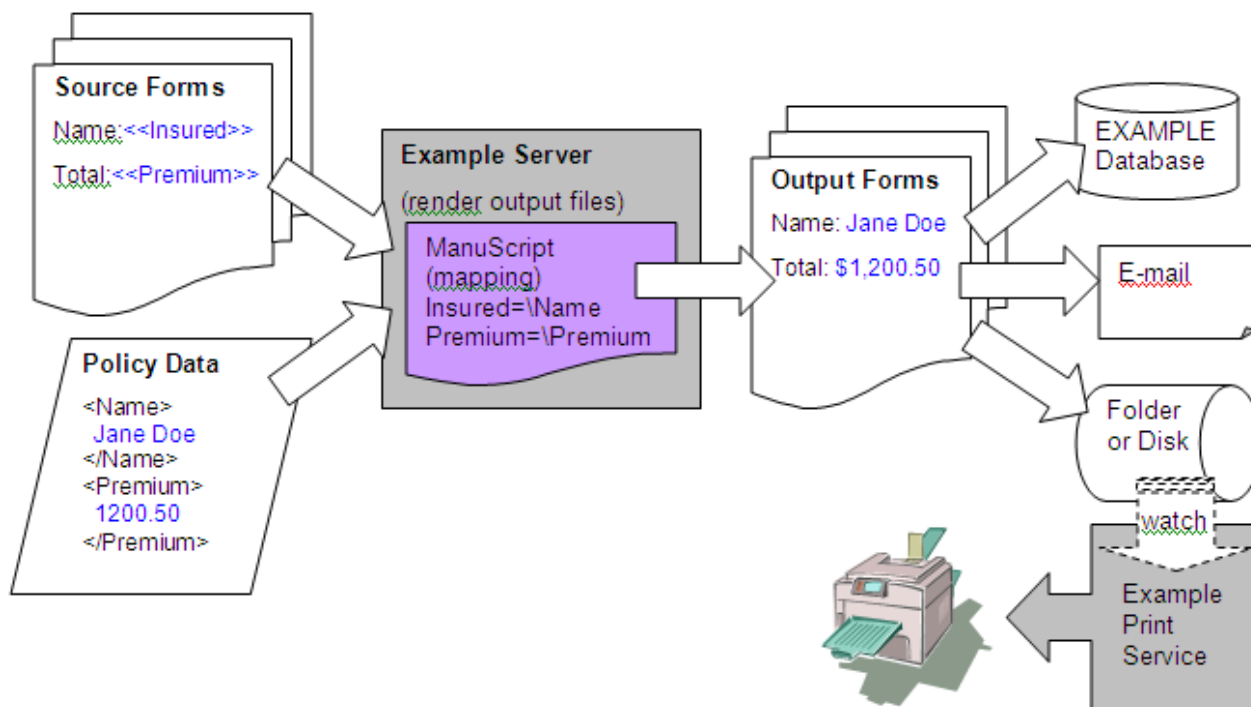
Level 1 Forms and Level 2 Forms services are provided through EXAMPLE Forms™ Support Services. These levels are available with initial installation. With Level 1 Forms, you can generate a flat XML file containing the names of the various forms to be printed from an external system based on the rules in a Manuscript. You can then send this XML list of forms and the associated Manuscript to the document provider to print. With Level 2 Forms, you can generate the same flat XML file of form names and also add the data to be placed on the forms. You can configure the order and format of that data in the Forms Mapper view in EXAMPLE Author®.

EXAMPLE Forms™ can also go beyond Support Services. You may obtain the ability to generate and print forms by purchasing an additional license for full EXAMPLE Forms™ use. With full EXAMPLE Forms™ use, you can create print jobs to generate forms at various points in the policy lifecycle. You can then save these forms to a specific folder, attach them to a policy, or email them. This is known as Level 3 Forms.



EXAMPLE Forms™ does not actually print the documents it produces. With Level 3 Forms, however, Duck Creek Technologies, Inc. does offer a print utility (EXAMPLE Form Print) that recognizes and prints generated forms on configured printers.

The graphic below illustrates the EXAMPLE Forms™ system.



How Is Forms Information Defined?

The EXAMPLE Forms™ product uses three basic components to define forms. These components include source documents, mapping information, and form properties.

Source Documents

Source documents are either .doc or .pdf documents. These documents include merge fields that will be populated at runtime when forms are generated. When creating .doc source documents, you use merge fields or the mail merge tool in Microsoft Word to create and define merge fields. When creating .pdf source documents, you use the Form Field tool in Adobe Acrobat Professional to create and define merge fields. Source documents are not used when only using EXAMPLE Forms™ to create XML data-feeds through EXAMPLE Forms™ Support Services (Forms Levels 1 and 2).

Mapping Information

Mapping information is contained in an EXAMPLE Manuscript™ and is defined in the EXAMPLE Author® Forms Mapper tool. Mapping information associates specific fields in a Manuscript with specific merge fields on a source document. For each merge field on a source document, you can define the data to be inserted when the form is rendered.

Form Properties

Form properties are also contained in an EXAMPLE Manuscript™ and are defined in the EXAMPLE Author® Forms Mapper tool.

Within Forms Mapper, you can define various properties for each form, including:

- Watermarks and stamps
- Conditions for generating the form
- Form caption
- Form category
- Print preferences

EXAMPLE Forms™ and Document Management Systems

The EXAMPLE Forms™ system offers two possible points of integration with third party document management systems (DMS). These two possibilities correspond to the two main divisions of EXAMPLE Forms™ capability: EXAMPLE Forms™ Support Services (Forms Levels 1 and 2) and full EXAMPLE Forms™ use (Forms Level 3).

EXAMPLE Forms™ Support Services generate an XML representation of forms that includes the data to be mapped on a form for a given policy. These XML documents do not include definition for the arrangement and presentation of the data on the printed page. As a result, a third party application must provide this ability through a Web service that converts the XML into printable documents. After merging data from the XML document onto a form, the third party application can then incorporate the printed form into its own document management system.

With full EXAMPLE Forms™ use, you can attach forms to a policy, save them to a folder, or e-mail them. To integrate forms with a document management system, you can save forms to a network folder. After generation, other third party applications can retrieve those forms from the network and incorporate them into their own document management systems.